

# Strengthening Educational Performance Up in Zambia

# STEP Up Zambia

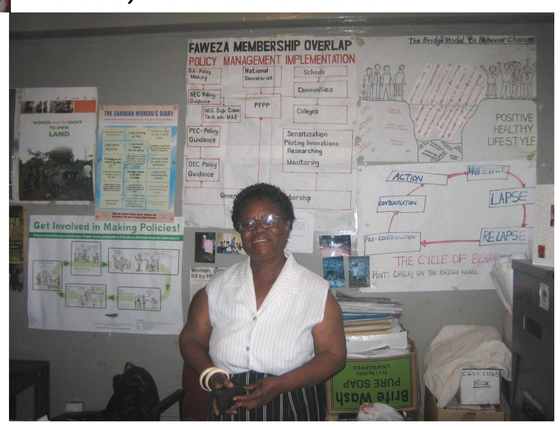
## Engaging Higher-Education Institutions in Education Policy Research and Analysis

*Under the Strengthening Educational Performance Up Zambia project (STEP-Up Zambia)*

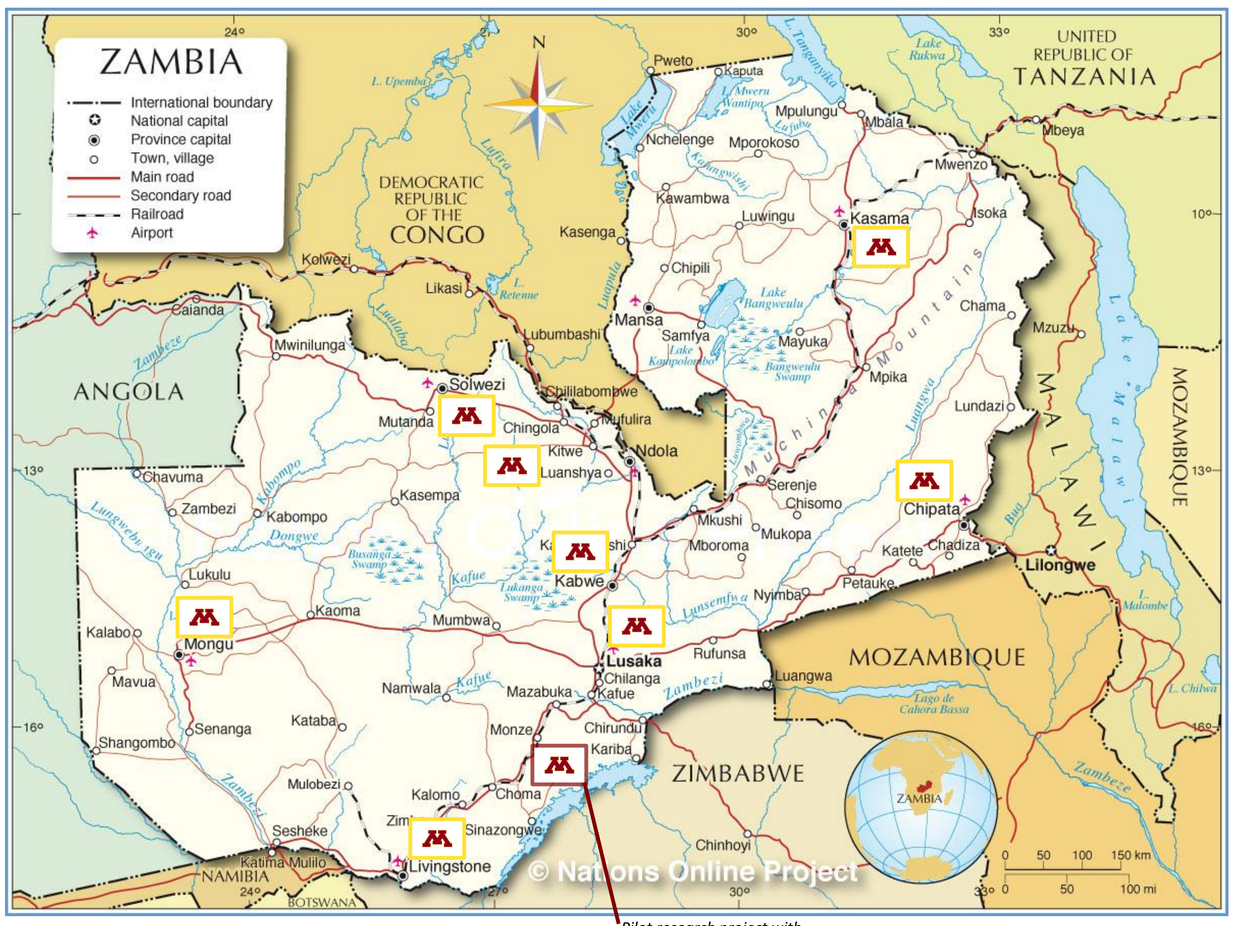


*STEP-Up Zambia seeks to strengthen educational achievement through improved management and leadership, building on existing practices.*

*Left: A primary school headteacher (principal) in her office with a "talking wall" (Eastern Province)*
*Below: A gender advisor in her office (Southern Province)*
*Photos by Heidi Eschenbacher*




The University of Minnesota (UMN) is working with higher education institutions and the Ministry of Education, Science, Vocational Training and Early Education (MESVTEE) to collaborate on research efforts to improve educational quality through management practices. This is a USAID-supported project contracted to Chemonics International. The UMN is a sub-contractor to Chemonics International on the STEP-Up Zambia project.




*Where have we been? We have traveled!*

*Pilot research project with Charles Lwanga College of Education*

*Members of the University of Minnesota team (David Chapman, Fran Vavrus, Heidi Eschenbacher, Matthew Thomas, Greg Sales, Roozbeh Shirazi) have traveled to the following locations to meet with higher education institutions, stakeholders and government representatives at provincial and district levels. In these meetings we have discussed how educational performance, particularly reading, can be improved using policy-focused research toward solving the most troubling issues in the Zambian educational system. This process of scoping out the interest and availability of potential partners to participate in research toward policy and practice improvements will result in internships and research studies focused on priority issues affecting learning in primary schools.*

Collaborative research efforts began in 2012 with a pilot research project with a teacher training college, the Charles Lwanga College of Education (CLCE). Under this initial effort, MESVTEE and lecturers met in November 2012 to develop a research study focused on three priority areas they identified: assessment techniques, monitoring and supervision, and teaching and learning materials. From January to March 2013 CLCE student teachers gathered data from their schools during their teaching practice using the instruments their lecturers and MESVTEE developed in November. Lessons from this pilot project will help to advance efforts between higher education institutions and MESVTEE to promote research as a means of informing policy from the school to district, provincial, and national levels.

The University of Minnesota management team for this sub-contract is Dr. David Chapman (principal investigator), Dr. Frances Vavrus (co-principal Investigator), and Dr. Heidi Eschenbacher.
Department of Organizational Leadership, Policy, and Development, College of Education and Human Development

UNIVERSITY OF MINNESOTA